telling her about his visiting Purshotamdas on Sundays for advice and guidance.

Parekh worked in the firm for two decades. For the first three years he was also a lecturer in Economics at the St Xavier's College in Bombay. He considered his two decade-long stint at the broking firm valuable as it not only gave him his most basic lessons in the business but also immensely contributed to his personal growth. During this period, Parekh continued to study and write on different aspects of the economy and economic policy, money and banking, and also participated in public discussions.

Driven by a deep interest in investment banking, Parekh joined the newly set up development finance institution, ICICI, as its Deputy General Manager in 1956. He rose to become its Chairman in 1972. Under his leadership, ICICI grew impressively to gain the acceptance of Indian business, recognition of the government, and even became a showpiece for the World Bank. Parekh retired as the Executive Chairman in December 1975, but continued to be honorary Chairman of the Board of Directors till 1978. By then ICICI had long become a financial landmark of India.

For decades Parekh had also been stressing the need for a financial corporation specializing in providing long-term finance for home ownership. At the age of sixty-six, his lifelong dream of helping Indians own their home, inspired by the institutions he saw when he was a student in the UK four decades ago, led to the formation of the Housing Development Finance Corporation Ltd (HDFC) in 1977. It was the first institution of its kind in the country and the fact that he set it up without any financial assistance from the Government of India, made the achievement even more extraordinary. Under Parekh's leadership, HDFC flourished while being strongly rooted in the principles of integrity, transparency, and professionalism. Parekh's management style was marked by large-heartedness and human considerations. As S.S. Nadkarni observed after Parekh passed away, 'H.T. Parekh built institutions, but more importantly he built the men who ran them.'[8] Deepak Satwalekar, while inaugurating the H.T. Parekh Convention Centre of the Ahmedabad Management Association in July 1999, echoed a similar sentiment when he observed that Parekh's biggest contribution was his approach to man-management.[9]

A small incident also tells us something more about the man. Parekh had an innate old world gravitas of proper etiquette, dignity, and charm. In the